Freezing: The microbial growth and the enzyme activity on the frozen food items can be prevented by this method. E.g. Fruits, Vegetables.

Boiling: Boiling kills the micro-organisms present in the food materials. E.g. Milk, Water.

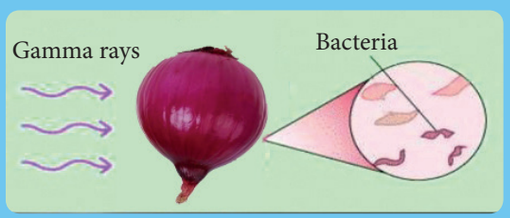
Canning: In this method, food is packed in air tight cans so that germs do not grow on them. E.g. Milk powder.

Addition of chemical preservatives: Chemical preservatives are added to stop the growth of micro-organisms in certain food materials. E.g. Sodium benzoate is added with fruits, Sulphur dioxide is added with dry fruits, Vinegar is added with pickles.



Do you know?

Irradiation is the modern method in which, food is exposed to gamma rays or ultra violet rays to kill the bacteria and the fungi. It does not affect the taste of the food or nutritive value of the foods. E.g. Onion, Potatoes.





2 Purpose of Food Preservation

Food production has increased due to modern technologies. Yes, agricultural practice is abandoned in many places as there is failure of monsoon. At the same time many people suffer in the world without food. So, food should not be wasted by any means. Preservation of food is important for the following reasons.

1. To retain the colour, taste and nutritive value of the food.
2. To make food available throughout the year.
3. To prevent the growth of micro-organisms like bacteria and fungi in the food items.
4. To reduce wastage of food items.
5. Preserving food not only protects our health but also makes food available to the people who need it.

5th_Science_Term_II_Unit_1_EM.indd 62 26-06-2020 11:50:58